have been agreed upon. Their expeditious and effective implementation holds the key to scaling up of Japanese business in India. Synchronizing Foreign Direct Investment and Official Development Assistance polices could help open up more pathways that could be beneficial to both parties. A noteworthy step was the creation of an Act East Forum to promote connectivity initiatives in India's North-East region and extend that to Bangladesh and Myanmar. This reflects the maturing of economic thinking into larger strategic policy.

Japan, of course, has a longstanding presence in the Indian economy and society. But, opportunities in India that opened up a quarter century ago did not evoke the expected response due to their over-caution as much as our own uncertainties. Competing demands from other growing economies were also a factor. Nevertheless, Japan was responsible for major technological upgrades of the Indian economy. An earlier generation of Indians will recall how much the arrival of the Maruti-Suzuki cars changed not just their transport but the way of life. The next generation probably feels the same about the Delhi Metro Rail project. The real value of Japan is its ability to impact entire sectors of the economy and help create new enterprises and capabilities. Whether India will use that as effectively as China and ASEAN did remains to be seen.

The enhanced salience of Japan to the Asian calculus is significant not just in terms of added capabilities but also greater comfort. The two nations have a shared commitment to democracy, tolerance, pluralism and open society. Their common traditions also strengthen this bonding. In Japan, India sees a partner committed to a peaceful, open, equitable, stable and rule-based order in the Indo-Pacific and beyond. This combination of interests and values are the basis for a stronger convergence today. Given the range of interests that both nations have, the relationship goes beyond its bilateral facet. Their regional intersection will see cooperation as net security providers, collaborating on connectivity and harmonizing interests in third countries.

At the global level, India and Japan could collaborate on climate change, terrorism and reform of the old world order. How they factor in each other's sensitivities will say much for this transforming relationship. On its part,